



River animals



Flying visitors

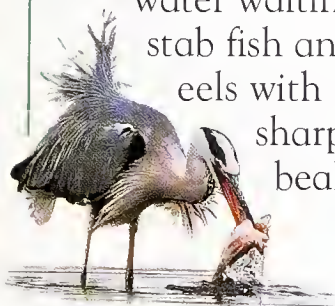


Bats swoop over rivers at night to catch small flying insects.



Kingfishers catch fish by diving headfirst into rivers.

Herons stand in the water waiting to stab fish and eels with their sharp beaks.



All kinds of animals live in or near the world's rivers. Strong swimmers live in fast-flowing rivers, but most animals choose quieter streams.



Water rat
Water rats make their homes in riverbanks.



Mayfly
Mayfly young are called larvae and live underwater. The adults fly in the air above.

Did you know?

Water beetles breathe underwater by trapping an air bubble under their wings.



Beaver

Beavers build dams across small rivers. They use trees they have felled with their sharp teeth.

The lodge is built with logs above the water level.

A beaver's home is called a lodge.



Water snake

Water snakes have thick, scaly skins to keep out water.

River



Dam

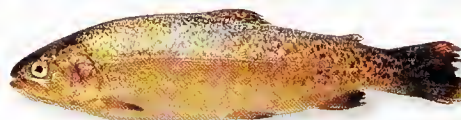
Leeches

Leeches cling to stones on riverbeds, so they won't be swept away.



River shellfish

These shellfish live in fast-flowing water. They feed on water plants.



Trout

Trout live in swift, shallow streams. The females lay their eggs in the riverbed.

Crayfish

Crayfish live in fast-flowing rivers, feeding on small fish and worms.

